



KSUM NEWSLETTER

February 2024

www.startupmission.kerala.gov.in

Kerala has around 5000 + startups working in various sectors spread across its 14 districts. Our startups work in wide range of sectors including Artificial Intelligence, Hardware, Healthcare, Fin tech, Bio Technology etc.

FEBRUARY 2024 EVENTS

LAUNCH OF KERALA'S FIRST CAMPUS INDUSTRIAL PARK & ZOHO R&D LABS



Kerala's First Campus Industrial Park & Zoho R&D Labs supported by Kerala Startup Mission, Zoho and IHRD was officially inaugurated by Shri Pinarayi Vijayan, Hon'ble Chief Minister of Kerala, at the College of Engineering IHRD, Kottarakkara on 19th February 2024. Shri K. N. Balagopal, Hon'ble Minister for Finance, describes the launch as a path-breaking initiative in Kerala's industrial ecosystem. Distinguished guests including Smt. Dr. R Bindu, Hon'ble Minister for Higher Education and Social Justice, Dr. Rathan U Kelkar, IAS Secretary - Information Technology, Government of Kerala, Shri Sridhar Vembu, Founder & CEO of Zoho, Shri Tony Thomas, Co-founder of Zoho, Dr Arun Kumar, Director of IHRD, and Shri Anoop Ambika, CEO of Kerala Startup Mission graced the occasion with their esteemed presence.



KERALA STARTUP MISSION HOSTS US TRADE EDUCATION MISSION



Kerala Startup Mission had the distinct honour of hosting distinguished representatives from the US Trade Education Mission, alongside esteemed representatives from the US Consulate and officials from 18 renowned US universities at KSUM, Kochi. The visit emphasised the importance of international partnerships in driving entrepreneurship and innovation.

LAUNCH OF LEAP CO-WORKS CENTRE KANNUR



Kerala Startup Mission's LEAP Co-Works Centre Kannur was officially inaugurated by Shri T V Rajesh, Chairman of KCCPL, at MiZone, Kannur on 23 February 2024. Shri Anoop Ambika, CEO of Kerala Startup Mission exchanged MoU regarding LEAP Co-Works Centre Kannur with Shri T V Rajesh. Distinguished guests including Shri Anakai Balakrishnan - Managing Director of KCCPL, Shri Shilen Sugunan - Chairman of Mizone, Dr A Madhavan - CEO of Mizone, and Shri Subhash Babu- Director of Mizone graced the occasion with their esteemed presence.



KSUM'S 'CO-FOUNDER: SPEED DATING' EVENT ON VALENTINE'S DAY



The Kerala Startup Mission in Kochi hosted a successful "Co-Founder: Speed Dating" event on Valentine's Day, connecting innovative co-founders through discussions and networking opportunities. The "Founders' Date" session matched individuals based on business ideas and expertise, fostering meaningful conversations and potential partnerships.

FOUNDERS MEET: 16TH EDITION



FOUNDERS MEET
16TH EDITION

Held at
Mizone Kannur

23 February
2024

Distinguished speakers, including Aronin Ponnappan, Shlien Sagunan and Anoop Ambika shared invaluable insights, providing a platform to navigate growth challenges.



The 16th edition of Founders Meet, held on 23 February 2024 at Mizone Kannur was a success. Distinguished speakers, including Aronin Ponnappan, Cofounder & CEO of Sastra Robotics, Shlien Sagunan, Chief Executive of SS Consulting, Kochi and Anoop Ambika, CEO of Kerala Startup Mission, shared invaluable insights. Participants connected with industry leaders and cultivated a vibrant network of founders, providing a platform to navigate growth challenges.



STARTUP 360 KANNUR EDITION



'Startup 360' was held on February 23, 2024, at MiZone Kannur, offering enlightening sessions and dynamic discussions to help startups grow. The program provides comprehensive assistance to founders in all aspects of their entrepreneurial journey, with speakers and fellow entrepreneurs making the experience unforgettable.



LEADER CONNECT



Kerala Startup Mission in collaboration with TiE Kerala organised the 'Leader Connect' Session at Kerala Startup Mission, Kochi on 1st February 2024. The event showcased the insights of Mr. Rajesh P, COO & Co-Founder of Wizr AI, and Mr. Saju James, Partner of Fragomen. Mr. Rajesh delved into his inspiring journey, unveiling his exit story from RapidValue, a global leader in Digital Product Engineering, renowned for providing services to top brands and Fortune 1000 companies.



OPEN UP 2024: EXPLORING FILMMAKING WITH INDIAN ADFILM MAKERS



Indian Adfilm makers, in collaboration with Kerala Startup Mission, have held "Open Up 2024," a day dedicated to filmmaking and creative exploration. The event, held on February 1st, 2024, was inaugurated by Shri Tom Thomas, COO of Kerala Startup Mission. Shri Shrikumar VA, Adfilm Maker and Chairman & MD of Push 360 gave an expert talk on 'Strategic Nuances of Ad Film Making'. Additionally, Shri Shelton Pinheiro, Executive Creative Director of Stark Communications, shared his invaluable insights on 'Ad Films to Movies'.



INNOVATION TOUR

Innovation Tour, a monthly event organised by Kerala Startup Mission for innovators, held on 03 February 2024 at KSUM Kochi Campus. Entrepreneurs with innovative startup ideas gathered to explore the diverse programs and schemes offered by KSUM to support their ventures.



THE GOOGLE DUET AI WORKSHOP IN ISC KOCHI



The Google Cloud Gen AI Labs: Duet AI event, held on 17 February 2024 at Integrated Startup Complex, Kochi, showcased the transformative power of AI in development, focusing on Google Cloud's Duet AI technology. Participants gained insights into leveraging AI for faster innovation, optimizing technology through automation, and unlocking new data insights. The event provided hands-on labs, demo stations, and networking opportunities with Google Cloud experts, equipping participants with practical knowledge on integrating Duet AI into their development processes.



LAUNCH OF SATELLITE CENTRE OF ERNAKULAM PUBLIC LIBRARY IN KSUM, KOCHI



The Satellite Center of Ernakulam Public Library was inaugurated by Shri T D Ramakrishnan, a renowned novelist and literary figure at Integrated Startup Complex, KSUM, Kochi, on 27th February 2024. The centre provides a range of resources and services, enhancing the entrepreneurial environment at KSUM. This collaboration brings knowledge and innovation together, allowing patrons to access a wealth of resources and services, further enriching the entrepreneurial ecosystem.



LAUNCH OF ERNAKULAM PUBLIC LIBRARY SATELLITE CENTRE AT KSUM KOCHI



Shri T D Ramakrishnan, renowned novelist and literary figure, inaugurated the Satellite Center of Ernakulam Public Library on 27th February 2024 at Integrated Startup Complex, KSUM, Kochi.



D2C INSIDER SESSION



The D2C Insider event, held on 24 February 2024, in Kochi gathered industry leaders to discuss the importance of omnichannel strategies for sustained success. Speakers like Manas Madhu, Nihal TC, Rahul Mamman, and Naseef Nazar shared their insights, emphasizing the transformative power of innovation. The session showcased the pioneering of female wellness products and the revolutionizing of snack foods.



AVGC-XR FOUNDERS MEET



Kerala Startup Mission organised an AVGC-XR Founders Meetup and Roundtable at ISC, Kochi on 24 February 2024. The event provided insights into collaboration and creation in the Indian market from leading founders disrupting immersive media, gaming, and entertainment, as well as key growth strategies and opportunities for scaling innovative ventures.





LAUNCH OF 'SCALE TO WEST AFRICA' CONCLAVE



Shri Anoop Ambika, CEO of Kerala Startup Mission, inaugurated the 'Scale to West Africa' conclave at C-DAC Technopark, Trivandrum organized by Neonicz Software Solutions in association with Kerala Startup Mission. In the event, held on 27 February 2024, around 15 startups presented their products and services to the Liberian delegation, seeking collaboration opportunities in various domains.



MEET THE MENTOR



Kerala Startup Mission, in association with Startup Infinity and Startup Middle East, hosted the MEET THE MENTOR webinar series. The session delved into the crucial topic of 'Understanding Organization Culture & Making it Work for You,' featuring esteemed guest speaker T.N. Hari, Executive Chairman of Steer Group, Co-Founder of Artha School of Entrepreneurship, Author, and Angel Investor.



The virtual webinar, held on 29th February 2024, attracted a diverse audience of entrepreneurs, startup enthusiasts, and industry professionals eager to gain insights into navigating organizational culture.



KERALA FORUM AT STARTUP INFINITY DUBAI



Kerala Startup Mission, Startup Infinity, Startup Middle East and Invest Kerala organized the "Kerala Forum" event on February 23, 2024, at Startup Infinity Dubai. The event aimed to discuss and explore investment opportunities in Kerala's thriving startup ecosystem. Attended by investors, entrepreneurs, and industry experts, the forum facilitated insightful discussions and networking opportunities. The event showcased Kerala as a promising destination for investment, highlighting its potential for growth and innovation, and exemplified the collective commitment to driving economic development and fostering entrepreneurship in the region.





GOVERNMENT AS A MARKETPLACE

KSUM facilitated 18 proposals from different startups for various Government Departments during the month of February. The Procurement Committee sanctioned proposals worth Rs 1.68 Crores. Details are as follows

Technical Committee for February approved 18 proposals

SI No	Name of the Department	Requirement	Startup	Amount Approved (in Lakhs)
01	Kudumbashree State Mission	Online Performance Appraisal & Review System	Travidux Technologies	5.3
02	KSCSTE-National Transportation Planning and Research Centre (NATPAC)	Mobile App for Road Data Collection	Exgratia Systems Pvt Ltd	4.85
03	DTPC Wayanad	Social Media Management & Digital Marketing	Niveosys Technologies Pvt Ltd	1.89
04	K-DISC	Hekaflo - High Flow Nasal Oxygen Therapy Machine	Heka Medicals India Private Limited	13.53

05	K-DISC	AI Based OP Token Slot Prediction System for Hospitals	Bagmo Private Limited	18.84
06	Department of Factories and Boilers	Development of Mobile Application- Complaint cum Grievances Redressal Application Software	Niveosys Technologies Private Limited	7.68
07	Department of Factories and Boilers	Development of Web Based Solution : e-Systematic Approachfor Facilitation and Enforcement in MSME Sector (e-SAFE)	Invendoi AI Solutions Pvt Ltd	46.61
08	Kerala Police	Upgrade of Police Station Website to latest Stable Version	Bitgenics Digital Ventures LLP	10.62
09	Kerala Police - Police Welfare Bureau	Software for Police Welfare Bureau	Travidux Technologies	4.5
10	Directorate of Culture	Website Development	Fintrens Ventures Pvt Ltd	2.65
11	Local Self Government Department	Revamping of LSGD Website	ThoughtRipples Technologies Private Limited	11.65
12	Technopark	Digital Marketing Agency	Fresh Mind Ideas Pvt. Ltd	2
13	Kudumbashree NRO	MIS System	Travidux Technologies	8.5
14	Horticorp	MIS System	Turqosoft	29.49
15	District Hospital Neyyatinkara	Organic Waste Converter and LITTER BIN	Floret Technologies	18.34
16	Directorate of Industrial training	Website Development	Bayesian Ways	9.44
17	Local Self Government Department	Route Tracking System - Waste Management	TeamStarbase Pvt Ltd	9.08
18	Directorate of Industrial training	Waste Management Surveillance System	Invendoi AI Solutions Pvt Ltd	25

01 FEBRUARY 2024 - 29 FEBRUARY 2024

No of EOIs	04
Project Under Evaluation	13
Value of work orders	2.18 cr
Active EOIs	1



RINK TECHNOLOGY OF THE MONTH

FEED FOR TILAPIA BY KERALA UNIVERSITY OF FISHERIES AND OCEAN STUDIES (KUFOS)

Description : The product was developed by replacing 50% of Soya Bean Meal (SBM) with Cashew Nut Meal (CNM) in the diet of tilapia. This is an all plant ingredient based feed. CNM, which is developed from cashew nut waste, is locally available at a much cheaper price than SBM. CNM appears to be a suitable ingredient at 40% incorporation level along with 20% soya bean meal in the diet of tilapia. In addition, CNM also exhibited the lowest economic conversion ratio in this replacement level.



To know more and obtain the product license,
write to : rink@startupmission.in





Playtime Gets An Upgrade: **"Marble Maze Labyrinth"**

Fun and innovation blend seamlessly in the Marble Maze Labyrinth, a recreational game designed by Sahrdaya College of Engineering and Technology alumni Joseph K.A., Joshua Sony C., Syam Krishna P.S. and Lakshmi Rajkumar M. Merging tactile gameplay and digital technology, this next-gen labyrinth provides an interactive experience for gamers of all ages.

At its core, the Marble Maze Labyrinth allows players to guide a marble through a challenging maze by tilting the physical structure using a joystick controller. This tight integration between tactile and digital interfaces creates tangible, real-time feedback, setting it apart from traditional video games. Players can create custom maze layouts and adjust difficulty settings, adding to its versatility.

Its inventors highlight the cognitive and developmental upsides that make this game more than just a plaything. Skills like spatial reasoning, problem-solving, creativity and motor functions can be honed through engaging gameplay. The project also introduces basic engineering concepts, potentially inspiring new interest in STEM fields.

From an accessibility standpoint, the use of easy-to-source Arduino components ensures the product remains affordable and replicable by schools, hobbyists and families. The team views this as a chance to foster innovation and spark young minds while keeping environmental impact low.

Looking forward, the Marble Maze Labyrinth may prove to be the first stepping stone for these ambitious entrepreneurs. Propelled by their appetite for learning and innate curiosity, their future creations could push boundaries even further. More broadly, the intersection of education and innovation stands to cultivate new ideas for the betterment of people and planet.

The journey continues as these innovators leverage technology to make learning joyful, memorable and inclusive. The Marble Maze Labyrinth offers just a glimpse into the promise of purpose-driven innovation.



MENTORSHIP



MENTORSHIP STATS

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STARTUPS

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MENTORS

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INTERACTIONS



FOUNDER TESTIMONIAL



Ms. Sangeetha Menon

It was like a breath of fresh air filled with hope and opportunities when I was introduced to Mr. Jagan Murugan. He completely understood my product and just deep-dived into my company pointing out all the avenues that we could go on with invaluable insights that got the wheels in my mind turning. The fact that he said that he would continue to mentor me and get my company and products on to programmes in colleges to create awareness, create optimal designs for services while constructing buildings, develop new products such as dismantlable buildings, work pods, and DIY low cost housing for communities in need has given me the much required wind beneath my wings. We express our sincere gratitude to the Kerala Startup Mission

FOUNDER TESTIMONIAL



I extend my sincere appreciation to KSUM for establishing the Startup Mentoring Program and acknowledge the professionalism displayed in orchestrating our diverse sessions and interactions.

HEDRAD EcoWasp Technology, a solution refined over a decade of research and rigorous testing, not only boasts a commendable product but also reflects Ms. Sangeetha Menon's surpassing dedication and love. Our exploration of the product, its variations, and engaging in brainstorming sessions enlightened us about customer requirements. Positive outcomes ensued, and strategies for marketing the product are being worked out for implementation.

Mentoring Ms. Sangeetha Menon and 'Team Hedrad' has proven to be an exceptional and enriching endeavor, with anticipation of a bright and fruitful future.



Mr. Jagan Murugan.



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Have a thought, comment or suggestion to share with us?

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